



P08 · 80 PAGES, WEEKS 6 TO 40

A Pregnancy Week-by-Week Journal

Eighty pages, two per week from week six through week forty. A spread per week, the kind that doesn't quiz you on whether you've drunk enough water. Body notes, mood, a partner page, and one small thing you don't want to forget.

Not a milestone tracker, a record of being there.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note before you start

I kept a pregnancy journal with my first. It asked me to rate my “glow” each week on a scale of one to ten. By week twelve I’d put it in a drawer.

This is the journal I went looking for after that one. Not a checklist. Not a chirpy companion. A place to put down what happened this week, what your body did, what you noticed, what scared you, what made you laugh in spite of everything.

You do not have to write something every week. There are no consequences for skipping a week. You will not “lose points.” If you write three lines on one week and a full page on the next, that is the right amount.

This journal does not assume forty smooth weeks. It does not assume one baby, or a first baby, or a planned pregnancy. It assumes you are pregnant now, however that came to be. That is the only entry requirement.

With care, Maya

This is not a medical record. If anything is concerning, call your provider. Your country’s emergency obstetric line should be saved in your phone before you need it. There is a numbers-to-keep page at the back.

Before you begin

A page to fill out once, before you go week by week.

WHY I AM KEEPING THIS

In one sentence, the reason I am writing in this journal:

WHO, IF ANYONE, WILL READ THIS

- ☐ No one but me
- ☐ My partner, eventually
- ☐ This baby, when they are old enough
- ☐ Not sure yet

WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER

The version of myself that is starting this journal,
in three words: _____

A FEW PRACTICAL FACTS

Due date (as best estimated): _____

Provider: _____

First appointment: _____

Hospital or birth location: _____

How this works

Two pages per week, weeks six through forty.

The left page is **yours**. Body, mood, what was new, the one thing you want to remember. The questions are the same every week, which is on purpose. You'll be tired of them by week thirty. That's fine. They are a low bar, not a high one.

The right page is **around you**. Appointments, partner notes, what you ate or didn't, anything that happened outside your body that was part of this week.

If a week passes and you write nothing, the page stays empty. Empty pages are part of the record too.

The weekly template

You will see this twice a week, every week, for the full forty.

— LEFT PAGE — WEEK ____

THIS WEEK MY BODY

Sleep: _____
Energy: _____
Appetite, what worked: _____
Appetite, what didn't: _____
New symptoms (any): _____
Old symptoms easing: _____

THIS WEEK MY MIND

One sentence about how I felt:

A worry I had this week (write it, don't argue with it):

A small good thing this week:

THE ONE THING I DO NOT WANT TO FORGET ABOUT THIS WEEK

— RIGHT PAGE — WEEK ____

APPOINTMENTS, MEASUREMENTS, NUMBERS

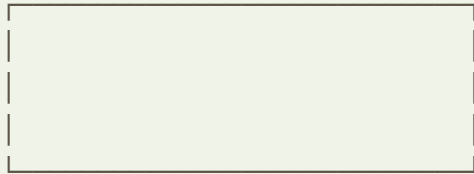
Appointment this week: ☐ yes ☐ no
What was measured: _____
Anything I asked about: _____
Next appointment: _____

PARTNER NOTES (or notes for whoever is here)

What they noticed this week:

What I want from them next week:

A SPACE FOR A STICKER, AN ULTRASOUND, OR A SMALL DRAWING



THREE LINES TO THE BABY (skip if you'd rather)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

You'll see that template thirty-five times. It will become familiar. The familiarity is the point. You stop deciding what to write about each week. You just answer.

Trimester one

Weeks six through thirteen.

Trimester one is mostly invisible. You probably haven't told many people yet. You feel terrible, possibly, and have to explain it as "I think I'm coming down with something." You are exhausted in a way that does not make sense to anyone around you, including, often, you.

You may also be terrified. Trimester one carries the highest risk of loss, and almost no one talks honestly about that fact in front of pregnant people. Carrying that quietly is a particular kind of hard.

Write what you want. Write very little, if that's all you have.

Week 6

A note: at six weeks, the baby is the size of a sweet pea. Your body is doing the most extraordinary thing it will ever do, and there is nothing yet to show for it. That is the gap that defines trimester one.

Week 7

Some questions for this week, if you want them:

- Who is the first person you told (or will tell)?
- What is the worst food smell so far?
- What time of day do you feel most yourself?

Week 8

The baby is now the size of a raspberry. The first ultrasound, for many providers, happens around now. If yours was earlier, write down what you saw and what was said.

Week 9

A note: most people lose two to ten pounds in trimester one if they have hyperemesis or nausea. Some people gain. Both are normal. Your scale is not a referendum on this pregnancy.

Week 10

This week's prompt, if you want one:

- Write down a fear you have not said out loud. The page can hold it.

Week 11

If you've had any genetic screening (NIPT, NT scan), this is often when results land. Write down what was said, what you understood, and what you don't.

Week 12

The traditional "second trimester is around the corner" week. The risk of loss drops sharply at the end of week twelve for most pregnancies, though never to zero. You are allowed to keep holding your breath. You are also allowed to slowly, slowly, exhale.

Week 13

The last week of trimester one. Some people start telling more widely now. Some wait longer. There is no correct date.

Trimester one reflection

A single page at the end of trimester one.

LOOKING BACK AT THE LAST TWELVE WEEKS

The hardest week, and why:

The easiest week:

Something I was scared of that did not happen:

Something I learned about myself:

A thing I want to keep doing in trimester two:

A thing I want to stop doing in trimester two:

Trimester two

Weeks fourteen through twenty-seven.

Trimester two is often called the honeymoon trimester. For some people it actually is. Energy returns. Nausea fades. Bodies start to show, and that brings a different kind of attention. For others, none of that lands, and they spend trimester two waiting for the famous good part. Both are normal.

This is also the trimester of anatomy scans, gestational diabetes testing, and (for many) the first real feel of the baby moving. Each of those gets a page.

Week 14

You may notice your appetite returning. Eat what you can. Pregnancy is not a wellness phase.

Week 15

A note: people will start saying “you look great” or “you barely look pregnant” or “you look really pregnant for fifteen weeks.” None of these are about you. They are about the speaker. You owe them nothing.

Week 16

Some people feel the first flutters this week, especially second pregnancies. It is described as bubbles, popcorn, a fish flicking. If you don't feel it yet, that is normal too.

Week 17

A prompt:

- What is one thing you bought this week (or didn't) that you have feelings about?

Week 18

Anatomy-scan week for many providers. Twenty-something measurements, a long quiet stretch, the technician's "let me get the doctor" that may be routine. Write down what you saw, what you were told, and what you are unsure of.

Week 19

Tape line, if you've started one. A piece of string measured around your belly each week, taped into the page. Optional. Old-school. Beautiful in retrospect.

Week 20

The halfway point. Twenty weeks behind, twenty ahead (give or take). A page that takes only one sentence:

- Halfway. What feels different about you, today, than the day you found out you were pregnant?

Week 21

The baby has now started a sleep-wake cycle. Often you'll notice the baby is more active in the evening, when you are still. That is the rhythm starting.

Week 22

A reminder, if it helps: a normal pregnancy includes weeks where nothing remarkable happens. The journal is for those weeks too.

Week 23

A prompt:

- Something I have changed my mind about since starting this pregnancy.

Week 24

Twenty-four weeks is the often-cited "viability" threshold. The technology to support a baby born now is real and improving. The emotional weight of crossing twenty-four is real too. Some people exhale here. Some never exhale.

Week 25

A prompt:

- Who am I telling the truth to about how this pregnancy is going? Anyone? Should I?

Week 26

A note: most people start to feel kicks visible from the outside around now. A partner pressing a hand to your belly and feeling it for the first time is one of the most-cited moments of pregnancy. Write down what they said, even if it was just "oh."

Week 27

The last week of trimester two. The end of "the easy one," for most.

Trimester two reflection

LOOKING BACK AT THE LAST FOURTEEN WEEKS

What I expected from trimester two:

What it actually was:

The biggest piece of news this trimester:

A way I have changed:

A thing I am noticing I am avoiding:

What I want to put down before trimester three:

Trimester three

Weeks twenty-eight through forty.

Trimester three is the long one. The one where it stops being possible to forget you are pregnant. The one where strangers start saying things they shouldn't. The one where the practical questions show up. Birth plan. Hospital bag. Maternity leave. Childcare. The room.

Energy is often a roller coaster. Some weeks feel fine. Some weeks feel like being underwater.

Week 28

The start of trimester three. The third hour of a movie, where you suddenly know how this ends. Twelve weeks left (give or take).

Week 29

A prompt:

- What is one practical thing I want to stop putting off?

Week 30

Three-quarters done. A reminder: this is a long marathon. You don't need to sprint the last ten weeks.

Week 31

The baby is starting to look like the baby in your head. Hair, fingernails, eyelashes. Write down the latest scan or measurement, if there was one.

Week 32

A prompt:

- A question I am embarrassed to ask my provider, written here so I can ask it next visit.

Week 33

Gestational diabetes screening, if not already done. Glucose-test stories are legend. Write down yours.

Week 34

A note: somewhere around now, your provider may start cervical checks. You can decline them if they are not medically necessary. You are allowed to ask whether they are.

Week 35

A prompt:

- What is one thing I want for the day I give birth that I have not told anyone yet?

Week 36

You are now considered late preterm if the baby comes this week. Most do not. But it's worth packing a small hospital bag by now, even half-packed. There is a hospital-bag list at the back.

Week 37

You are full-term. The baby is not, biologically, in a hurry. Most first babies arrive around week 40 or 41. Some arrive now. The waiting begins in earnest.

Week 38

A prompt:

- A piece of advice I keep getting that I plan to ignore.

Week 39

Last week of week-by-week, statistically speaking. If the baby comes now, you are within the normal window. If not, write a page about waiting. The waiting is part of the story.

Week 40

The week. Or not. If you go past forty (most first-time moms do), you are not late. You are exactly on time, your time.

Trimester three reflection

LOOKING BACK AT THE LAST TWELVE WEEKS

The hardest week, and why:

The thing I'm proudest of getting through:

What I'm carrying into birth:

What I want to leave behind:

If I could tell my week-six self one thing:

The night before

A single page at the end of the journal. For whenever that night is. Week 39, week 40, week 41, week 42.

You are about to do the thing.

Or, more likely, the thing is going to start happening to you and you are going to figure it out as you go.

Either way, you are not the same person who started this journal. You will not be the same person tomorrow. Today is the last day of being the version of you who has only been pregnant. There will not be another day like it.

Here are three things to write down before you close the journal.

One. What is one thing you want to remember about your body, today, before it becomes someone else's reference point?

Two. What is one thing you are scared of about tomorrow, written so it lives on the page and not just in your head?

Three. What is one thing you'd like to say to the baby, before they are a person you can talk to?

That's it. Close the journal. The next time you open it, you'll be on the other side.

Soothemade.

A symptom reference

Plain language. Not medical advice. If you are worried, call.

What's normal

- Mild headaches, especially trimester one
- Heartburn, especially trimester three
- Constipation, throughout
- Round-ligament pain (sharp, brief, on the sides), trimester two
- Braxton Hicks contractions, irregular tightenings, trimester three
- Shortness of breath when the baby is high, trimester three
- Trouble sleeping, trimester three (your body is rehearsing for the newborn)
- Swelling in the feet at the end of the day
- More vivid dreams
- Stronger sense of smell
- Mood swings, in all trimesters

What to call about

- Vaginal bleeding (any amount, any trimester)
- Severe abdominal pain that does not ease
- A sudden severe headache that does not respond to water and rest
- Vision changes (spots, flashes, blurriness)
- Sudden severe swelling, especially face and hands
- A noticeable decrease in baby's movement after week 28 (do a kick count, then call)
- Leaking fluid (could be water breaking)

- Fever above 101°F
- Painful urination
- Itching all over the body, especially palms and soles, trimester three
- Persistent vomiting in any trimester

What to go in for

- Heavy bleeding
- Contractions that are five minutes apart, lasting one minute, for one hour (before week 37 these are preterm labor signs)
- A trickle or gush of fluid
- Severe pain anywhere
- Significantly reduced fetal movement after a kick count
- Any feeling that something is very wrong

Numbers to keep

A page at the very back.

PROVIDER

Name: _____ Practice: _____

Phone: _____ After-hours: _____

MIDWIFE (if applicable)

Name: _____ Phone: _____

DOULA (if applicable)

Name: _____ Phone: _____

HOSPITAL OR BIRTH CENTER

Name: _____ Address: _____

Labor & delivery direct line: _____

PEDIATRICIAN (for after)

Name: _____ Phone: _____

PARTNER (in case I am asked who to call)

Name: _____ Phone: _____

ANOTHER PERSON TO CALL

Name: _____ Phone: _____

INSURANCE

Member ID: _____

Group: _____

US PRENATAL DEPRESSION + ANXIETY LINE

1-833-852-6262 (24/7, free, confidential)

US SUICIDE & CRISIS LIFELINE

988 (call or text, 24/7)



From Soothemade Notes, a small apothecary of printables, planners, and cards for the unphotographed parts of new parenthood. Made slowly, in plain language.



Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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